

Northbridge Analytics Pvt. Ltd.

Employee Policy Manual

Covering Employee Benefits, Leave, Transport, Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH), Dress Code, Regulatory Compliance, Working Hours, and Data Protection

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1. Introduction & Applicability

This Employee Policy Manual ('the Manual') sets out the human resource policies, standards, and expectations applicable to all employees of Northbridge Analytics Pvt. Ltd. ('the Company'), including full-time, part-time, probationary, and contractual employees, unless a specific policy states otherwise. The Manual is designed to ensure fairness, transparency, and regulatory compliance across all Company locations in India.

This Manual supersedes all previous versions of HR policy documents, circulars, or verbal communications on the same subject matter. In case of conflict between this Manual and an employee's individual offer letter or employment contract, the terms more beneficial to the employee shall prevail, unless prohibited by law.

The Company reserves the right to amend, modify, add to, or withdraw any policy contained in this Manual at its sole discretion, with reasonable prior notice to employees wherever practicable. Continued employment after such amendment constitutes acceptance of the revised policy.

1.1 Definitions

Term	Definition
Company	Northbridge Analytics Pvt. Ltd. and its subsidiaries/branch offices in India.
Employee	Any individual on the permanent, probationary, or fixed-term payroll of the Company.
Reporting Manager	The individual to whom an employee directly reports as per the organizational hierarchy.
HR Department	The Human Resources function responsible for administering this Manual.
Working Day	Monday to Friday, excluding declared public holidays.

2. Employee Benefits Policy

The Company is committed to providing a comprehensive and competitive benefits program to support the health, financial security, and overall wellbeing of its employees. Eligibility for each benefit is subject to the employee's grade, employment type, and confirmation status, as detailed below.

2.1 Health & Insurance Benefits

- **Group Medclaim Insurance (GMC):** All confirmed employees and their dependents (spouse and up to two children) are covered under a floater Group Medclaim policy with a sum insured of INR 5,00,000 per family, effective from the date of joining.
- **Group Personal Accident Insurance (GPA):** Coverage of INR 10,00,000 per employee against accidental death or permanent disability, effective from date of joining, at no cost to the employee.
- **Group Term Life Insurance (GTLI):** Coverage equal to 3x annual CTC (minimum INR 15,00,000), payable to the nominee in the event of death of the employee during service.
- **Parental Insurance (Optional):** Employees may opt to add parents/parents-in-law to a co-paid parental health cover, with premium recovered through monthly payroll deduction.
- **Annual Health Check-up:** Employees above the age of 30, and all employees at Manager grade and above, are entitled to one fully sponsored annual health check-up at empanelled diagnostic centres.

2.2 Retirement & Financial Benefits

- **Provident Fund (PF):** Statutory contribution as per the Employees' Provident Funds & Miscellaneous Provisions Act, 1952 — 12% of Basic + DA contributed by both employee and employer.
- **Gratuity:** Payable as per the Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972, to employees who have completed 5 or more years of continuous service, at the rate of 15 days' wages for every completed year of service.
- **National Pension Scheme (NPS):** Voluntary employer-matched contribution up to 10% of Basic salary under Section 80CCD(2) of the Income Tax Act, 1961, available to all confirmed employees.
- **Meal Card / Food Coupons:** Tax-efficient meal allowance of up to INR 2,200 per month, loaded onto a company-issued prepaid meal card.
- **Flexible Benefits Plan (FBP):** Employees at Assistant Manager grade and above may structure a portion of CTC across LTA, telephone reimbursement, fuel & maintenance, and books & periodicals allowances.

2.3 Leave & Time-Off Benefits

Detailed under Section 3 (Leave Policy) of this Manual, including parental leave, sabbaticals, and encashment provisions.

2.4 Wellness & Lifestyle Benefits

- **Employee Assistance Program (EAP):** Confidential 24x7 counselling helpline covering mental health, financial, and legal advisory, available to employees and their immediate family, at no cost.
- **Gym / Fitness Reimbursement:** Reimbursement of up to INR 1,500 per month towards a gym membership or fitness app subscription, on production of valid receipts.
- **Learning & Development Allowance:** Annual allowance of INR 25,000 per employee for job-related certifications, conferences, or online courses, subject to Reporting Manager approval.

- **Employee Referral Bonus:** INR 15,000–INR 75,000 depending on the grade of the referred and successfully onboarded candidate, paid after the new hire completes 90 days of service.
- **Long Service Awards:** Recognition and cash awards at the completion of 5, 10, 15, and 20 years of continuous service.

2.5 Maternity & Parental Benefits

- Maternity benefits as per the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961 (as amended in 2017) — 26 weeks of paid maternity leave for the first two children, and 12 weeks for the third child onwards.
- Creche facility or creche reimbursement of up to INR 5,000 per month for employees with children below the age of 6 years, at locations with 50 or more employees, as mandated by law.
- Paternity leave of 15 calendar days, to be availed within 6 months of the child's birth or adoption.
- Adoption leave equivalent to maternity/paternity leave entitlement for legally adopted children below the age of 3 months.

2.6 Eligibility Matrix

Benefit	Eligible Employees	Applicable From
GMC / GPA / GTLI Insurance	All employees	From date of joining
Provident Fund	All employees (statutory)	From date of joining
Gratuity	Employees with 5+ years' service	On separation/retirement
Flexible Benefits Plan	Assistant Manager and above	After confirmation
L&D; Allowance	All confirmed employees	After confirmation
Sabbatical Leave	Employees with 3+ years' service	On approval

Note: All benefit amounts, sums insured, and eligibility criteria are subject to periodic revision by the Company and applicable insurer terms. The most current Summary of Benefits is published on the internal HR portal.

3. Leave Policy

This policy governs the types, entitlement, accrual, and procedure for availing leave by employees of the Company. The leave year runs from 1 January to 31 December.

3.1 Types of Leave & Annual Entitlement

Leave Type	Entitlement	Key Conditions
Casual Leave (CL)	12 days/year	Accrued at 1 day/month; for short personal exigencies; cannot be combined with more than 3 consecutive days without manager approval.
Sick Leave (SL)	12 days/year	Accrued at 1 day/month; medical certificate required beyond 2 consecutive days.
Privilege/Earned Leave (PL/EL)	18 days/year	Accrued at 1.5 days/month; can be accumulated up to 45 days and encashed as per Clause 3.5.
Maternity Leave	26 weeks	As per the Maternity Benefit Act, 1961; see Section 2.5.
Paternity Leave	15 days	To be availed within 6 months of childbirth/adoption.
Bereavement Leave	5 days	In the event of death of an immediate family member (spouse, child, parent, sibling).
Marriage Leave	5 days	One-time entitlement for the employee's own wedding, with 15 days' advance notice.
Sabbatical Leave	Up to 90 days (unpaid)	For employees with 3+ years' service, subject to business approval; job guarantee not assured beyond 60 days.
Compensatory Off	As accrued	Granted for approved work on holidays/weekly-offs; must be availed within 60 days of accrual.

3.2 Application Procedure

3.2.1 Planned leave (CL/PL) must be applied through the HR Information System (HRIS) at least 3 working days in advance and approved by the Reporting Manager prior to availing it.

3.2.2 Sick leave may be applied on the day of absence or the following working day, with intimation to the Reporting Manager by telephone, email, or instant message.

3.2.3 Leave exceeding 3 consecutive working days requires the Reporting Manager and next-level approver's sign-off.

3.2.4 Unapproved absence from work for more than 3 consecutive working days without communication may be treated as 'Absconding' and may attract disciplinary action, including termination, as per the Company's Conduct Policy.

3.3 Public Holidays

The Company observes a minimum of 10 declared public holidays annually, including 3 national holidays (Republic Day, Independence Day, Gandhi Jayanti) which are mandatory and non-substitutable. The remaining restricted holidays are notified location-wise at the start of the calendar year and employees may choose from an approved list based on regional/religious observance.

3.4 Leave Without Pay (LWP)

Where an employee has exhausted all applicable leave balances, further absence will be treated as Leave Without Pay and a pro-rata deduction will be made from the employee's monthly salary. LWP exceeding 30 continuous days requires written approval from the Head of HR and may affect increment and PF contribution continuity as per statutory provisions.

3.5 Leave Encashment & Carry-Forward

- Privilege Leave may be accumulated up to a maximum of 45 days; balances beyond this cap will lapse at the end of the calendar year unless carried forward with HR approval.
- Employees may encash up to 10 days of accumulated Privilege Leave annually, subject to a minimum balance of 15 days remaining post-encashment.
- Casual Leave and Sick Leave do not carry forward beyond the calendar year and are not eligible for encashment, except on full and final settlement at separation, where applicable by state Shops & Establishments regulations.
- On separation, all eligible unutilized Privilege Leave will be encashed at the employee's last drawn Basic salary, as part of the full and final settlement.

4. Transport Policy

This policy outlines the Company's provisions for employee commute, including company-provided transport, reimbursement of commute costs, and safety guidelines, applicable to employees working from Company office locations.

4.1 Company-Provided Transport

- Pick-up and drop cab facility is provided to all employees for shifts starting before 8:00 AM or ending after 8:00 PM, on designated routes within a 25-km radius of the office location.
- Women employees availing late-night transport (after 8:00 PM) will be provided doorstep drop, and no employee will be the last passenger dropped off; a security guard or driver-partner escort will accompany the last two drops as needed.
- All Company-arranged vehicles are GPS-tracked, and trip details are monitored by the Admin/Security team in real time.
- Employees must board and alight only from designated and approved pick-up/drop points unless prior exception is approved by the Transport Desk.
- Sharing of Company transport with unauthorized persons is strictly prohibited.

4.2 Self-Commute Reimbursement

- Employees at Manager grade and above who use personal vehicles may claim fuel reimbursement as part of the Flexible Benefits Plan (Section 2.2), subject to submission of valid fuel bills and vehicle documents.
- Employees using public transport / auto / app-based cabs for official travel between client sites or offices during working hours may claim reimbursement as per the Travel & Expense Policy, on submission of valid receipts through the expense management system.

4.3 Parking Facilities

Where available, the Company provides designated two-wheeler and four-wheeler parking at office premises on a first-come, first-served basis, subject to registration with the Admin team. The Company is not liable for loss, theft, or damage to personal vehicles parked on Company premises; employees are advised to use appropriate locks and are encouraged to insure their vehicles.

4.4 Safety & Conduct in Transport

- 4.4.1** Employees must wear seatbelts in cabs and use helmets where two-wheeler transport is arranged.
- 4.4.2** Any safety incident, harassment, or misconduct by a driver or co-passenger during Company-provided transport must be reported immediately to the Transport Desk and, where relevant, invoke the POSH Policy (Section 5).
- 4.4.3** Consumption of alcohol or smoking inside Company vehicles is strictly prohibited.
- 4.4.4** Drivers/vendors engaged for Company transport are subject to background verification and periodic audits by the Admin/Security function.

5. Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH) Policy

The Company is committed to providing a safe, respectful, and inclusive workplace, free from sexual harassment in any form. This policy is framed in accordance with the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013 ('the POSH Act') and applies to all employees, interns, trainees, contractors, vendors, and visitors at any Company location or Company-related event.

5.1 Definition of Sexual Harassment

Sexual harassment includes any one or more unwelcome acts or behaviour, whether directly or by implication, including but not limited to:

- Physical contact and advances of a sexual nature;
- A demand or request for sexual favours;
- Sexually coloured remarks, jokes, or gestures;
- Showing pornography or sexually explicit content;
- Any other unwelcome physical, verbal, or non-verbal conduct of a sexual nature, including through digital/electronic communication (email, chat, social media).

5.2 Internal Committee (IC)

The Company has constituted an Internal Committee at each administrative unit/office location employing 10 or more persons, as mandated under Section 4 of the POSH Act. The IC comprises:

- A Presiding Officer — a senior woman employee;
- Not less than two Members from among employees committed to the cause of women or with relevant experience;
- One external Member from an NGO or association committed to the cause of women, or familiar with issues of sexual harassment, to ensure impartiality.

The names and contact details of current IC members are published on the HR portal and displayed on notice boards at all office locations.

5.3 Complaint Procedure

5.3.1 An aggrieved employee may submit a written complaint to the IC within 3 months of the incident (extendable by the IC for reasons recorded in writing).

5.3.2 The IC shall complete the inquiry within 90 days of receipt of the complaint.

5.3.3 During the inquiry, the IC may recommend interim measures such as transfer of either party or granting leave to the aggrieved employee, up to 3 months.

5.3.4 On completion of the inquiry, the IC shall submit its report with recommendations to the employer within 10 days, and the Company shall act on the recommendations within 60 days.

5.3.5 Where the allegation is proved false or malicious, the IC may recommend action against the complainant; however, mere inability to substantiate a complaint shall not by itself attract action against the complainant.

5.4 Confidentiality & Non-Retaliation

The identity of the complainant, respondent, and witnesses, and the contents of the complaint, inquiry proceedings, and recommendations, shall be kept strictly confidential, except as required for the purposes of the inquiry. Any act of retaliation, victimization, or intimidation against a complainant, witness, or IC member is a serious disciplinary offence and may result in termination of employment.

5.5 Training & Awareness

All employees are required to complete mandatory POSH awareness training within 30 days of joining and undergo annual refresher training. The Company files an Annual Report with the District Officer as required under Section 21 of the POSH Act.

6. Dress Code Policy

The Company follows a 'Business Casual' dress code aimed at maintaining a professional yet comfortable work environment, while respecting individual expression within professional norms.

6.1 General Guidelines (Business Casual — Monday to Thursday)

Category	Guideline
Men	Collared shirts/polo T-shirts, chinos/formal trousers, closed or semi-formal footwear. Formal blazers required for client-facing meetings.
Women	Shirts, blouses, kurtas/kurtis, trousers, skirts (knee-length or longer), sarees, or salwar-kameez. Closed or semi-formal footwear preferred.
All Employees	Clothing should be clean, neat, and in good repair. Visible undergarments, ripped/torn clothing, and clothing with offensive graphics or language are not permitted.

6.2 Casual Fridays & Non-Client-Facing Days

Employees may wear smart-casual attire, including well-maintained jeans and T-shirts, on Fridays and days without scheduled client or external stakeholder interaction. Gym wear, beachwear, flip-flops, and clothing with distressed/torn finishes remain prohibited at all times.

6.3 Client-Facing & Formal Occasions

Employees attending client meetings, official Company events, or representing the Company externally are required to be in formal business attire (suits/blazers, formal shirts and trousers/sarees/formal Indian wear) regardless of the day of the week.

6.4 Health, Safety & Cultural Considerations

- Employees working in locations with specific safety requirements (e.g., server rooms, warehouses) must comply with additional Personal Protective Equipment (PPE) norms as specified by the Facilities/Safety team.
- Religious and cultural attire (e.g., turbans, hijabs, bindis) is respected and permitted at all times.
- Reasonable accommodations to this policy will be made for employees with disabilities or medical conditions upon request to HR.

6.5 Non-Compliance

Repeated non-adherence to the dress code, after verbal counselling by the Reporting Manager or HR, may result in formal documentation and be considered in the employee's conduct evaluation.

7. Compliance Policy

The Company is committed to conducting its business with integrity and in full compliance with applicable laws, regulations, and internal standards. Every employee is responsible for understanding and adhering to the compliance obligations relevant to their role.

7.1 Code of Conduct

- Employees must act with honesty, integrity, and fairness in all business dealings with colleagues, clients, vendors, and regulators.
- Conflicts of interest, whether financial, familial, or otherwise, must be disclosed to the Reporting Manager and Compliance team promptly upon identification.
- Employees must not accept or offer gifts, hospitality, or favours that could be construed as an attempt to influence business decisions, beyond nominal value (INR 2,500) as per the Company's Gift & Hospitality Guidelines.

7.2 Anti-Bribery & Anti-Corruption

The Company maintains a zero-tolerance approach to bribery and corruption, in compliance with the Prevention of Corruption Act, 1988, and applicable international anti-bribery laws where the Company conducts cross-border business. Employees must never offer, promise, give, or accept any bribe, kickback, or improper payment, whether directly or through a third party.

7.3 Anti-Money Laundering & Sanctions

Employees in finance, procurement, and client-facing roles must comply with the Company's Know-Your-Customer (KYC), Anti-Money Laundering (AML), and Sanctions Screening procedures before onboarding vendors or clients, and must report suspicious transactions to the Compliance Officer immediately.

7.4 Whistleblower / Vigil Mechanism

- The Company maintains a confidential Whistleblower Policy enabling employees to report suspected fraud, financial irregularities, ethical violations, or breaches of this Manual without fear of retaliation.
- Reports may be made via the dedicated ethics hotline, a confidential email address monitored by the Ethics Committee, or directly to the Audit Committee for matters involving senior management.
- Retaliation against a good-faith whistleblower is strictly prohibited and constitutes grounds for disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

7.5 Regulatory & Statutory Compliance

The Company complies with applicable labour laws (including the Shops & Establishments Act, the Payment of Wages Act, 1936, the Minimum Wages Act, 1948, the Employees' Provident Funds Act, 1952, and the Payment of Gratuity Act, 1972), tax laws, corporate governance norms under the Companies Act, 2013, and applicable data protection regulations. Statutory registers, returns, and filings are maintained and audited periodically by the Compliance and Finance functions.

7.6 Consequences of Non-Compliance

Violation of this Compliance Policy may result in disciplinary action ranging from a written warning to termination of employment, and, where applicable, referral to law enforcement authorities. The Company

reserves the right to recover any financial loss caused by an employee's non-compliance, subject to due process.

8. Working Hours Policy

This policy defines standard working hours, attendance expectations, overtime provisions, and flexible working arrangements applicable to all employees, in line with applicable Shops & Establishments regulations of the respective state.

8.1 Standard Working Hours

Parameter	Timing	Remarks
Standard Shift	9:30 AM – 6:30 PM	Monday to Friday, including a 1-hour lunch break
Core Hours	11:00 AM – 4:00 PM	Mandatory presence/availability window for all employees under flexible timing
Weekly Off	Saturday & Sunday	Except for employees on rotational/shift rosters
Total Weekly Hours	45 hours	Inclusive of breaks, as per Shops & Establishments norms

8.2 Flexible Working & Hybrid Arrangements

- Employees may choose a flexible start time between 8:00 AM and 10:30 AM, provided they complete 9 working hours (including a 1-hour break) and are available during Core Hours.
- Eligible roles may work in a hybrid model of up to 2 days' remote work per week, subject to Reporting Manager approval and business/client requirements.
- Fully remote arrangements require written approval from the Department Head and HR, and are reviewed on a quarterly basis.

8.3 Attendance & Late Coming

- Attendance must be marked daily through the biometric/HRIS system at the start and end of the working day.
- More than 3 instances of late coming (beyond 15 minutes of the chosen start time) in a calendar month will result in a counselling notice from HR; recurring instances may lead to a proportionate leave deduction.

8.4 Overtime

Where operational requirements necessitate work beyond standard hours, eligible non-managerial employees (as defined under applicable state Shops & Establishments Act) will be compensated with overtime pay at twice the ordinary rate of wages, or compensatory time off, in accordance with statutory requirements. Overtime must be pre-approved by the Reporting Manager and logged in the HRIS.

8.5 Breaks

Employees are entitled to a 1-hour lunch break and are encouraged to take short breaks through the day to support wellbeing. No employee shall be required to work for more than 5 consecutive hours without a break, in accordance with applicable labour regulations.

8.6 Shift Workers

Employees on rotational shifts (e.g., operations, support functions) follow a separate shift roster published at least 7 days in advance, with shift allowances and night-shift transport provisions applicable as per the Shift Allowance Policy published on the HR portal.

9. Data Protection Policy

The Company is committed to protecting the privacy and security of personal data belonging to employees, customers, vendors, and other stakeholders, in compliance with the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 ('DPDP Act'), the Information Technology Act, 2000 and associated Rules, and applicable international frameworks (such as the GDPR) where the Company processes data of overseas data principals.

9.1 Scope & Definitions

- **Personal Data:** Any data about an individual who is identifiable by or in relation to such data.
- **Sensitive Personal Data:** Includes financial information, health records, biometric data, and other categories designated as sensitive under applicable law.
- **Data Principal:** The individual to whom the personal data relates.
- **Data Fiduciary:** The Company, as the entity determining the purpose and means of processing personal data.

9.2 Principles of Data Processing

9.2.1 Personal data shall be collected only for lawful, specific, and clearly communicated purposes, and with the consent of the data principal where required.

9.2.2 Data collected shall be limited to what is necessary for the stated purpose (data minimization).

9.2.3 Personal data shall be kept accurate and up to date, and corrected or erased without delay where inaccurate.

9.2.4 Personal data shall not be retained for longer than necessary for the purpose for which it was collected, subject to statutory retention requirements.

9.2.5 Appropriate technical and organizational security safeguards shall be implemented to protect personal data against unauthorized access, loss, or misuse.

9.3 Employee Data Handling

- Employee personal data (including compensation, performance records, health information, and background verification results) is accessible only to authorized HR personnel and the employee's immediate Reporting Manager on a need-to-know basis.
- Employees handling customer or vendor personal data in the course of their duties must complete mandatory Data Protection training within 30 days of joining and annually thereafter.
- Use of personal cloud storage, personal email, or unauthorized third-party applications to store or transmit Company or customer personal data is strictly prohibited.
- Any suspected data breach must be reported to the Data Protection Officer (DPO) within 24 hours of discovery, to enable timely assessment and, where required, notification to the Data Protection Board and affected data principals within statutory timelines.

9.4 Data Subject Rights

Employees and other data principals have the right to access, correct, and request erasure of their personal data held by the Company, subject to legal and legitimate business retention requirements, and the right to withdraw previously given consent and to nominate another individual to exercise these rights in the event of death or incapacity, as provided under the DPDP Act, 2023. Requests may be raised with

the DPO via the internal Data Rights Request Form.

9.5 Data Security Measures

- Role-based access controls, multi-factor authentication, and encryption of data at rest and in transit are implemented across Company systems handling personal data.
- Company-issued laptops are configured with disk encryption, endpoint detection, and remote-wipe capability in the event of loss or theft, which must be reported to IT Security immediately.
- Access to production systems and customer data environments is logged and periodically audited by the Information Security team.

9.6 Third-Party Data Sharing

Personal data shall be shared with third-party vendors or processors only under a signed Data Processing Agreement (DPA) that mandates equivalent data protection standards, and only to the extent necessary for the specific business purpose. Cross-border transfer of personal data shall comply with any country-specific restrictions notified by the Central Government under the DPDP Act, 2023.

9.7 Consequences of Violation

Any employee found to have violated this Data Protection Policy, whether through negligence or intentional misconduct, will be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment, and may be held personally liable under applicable law where the violation involves wilful or grossly negligent conduct.

10. Policy Acknowledgement

All employees are required to read, understand, and formally acknowledge this Employee Policy Manual within 7 days of joining the Company, and to re-acknowledge any material revisions communicated by HR from time to time. Acknowledgement is recorded electronically through the HR Information System.

Field	Details
Employee Name	_____
Employee ID	_____
Department	_____
Date of Acknowledgement	_____
Signature	_____

For queries relating to any policy contained in this Manual, employees may contact the HR Department at hr.support@northbridgeanalytics.example or the Data Protection Officer at dpo@northbridgeanalytics.example.

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This is a sample/template policy manual prepared for illustrative and internal knowledge-base purposes; it should be reviewed by qualified legal counsel and adapted to the organization's actual jurisdiction, industry, and workforce before formal adoption.